

Chapter

The Guru — A Bridge Between Science and Spirituality



Introduction: Today's Questioning Person

Today's person asks questions. Faith alone is not enough; they want reasons, they want logic. Why does spirituality feel distant to such a person, and who can answer them? In this short discourse, Acharya Upendra Ji raises exactly this question — and explains why, in this age, it is essential for the Guru to speak in the language of science.

Body, Mind, Intellect and Soul

Acharya Ji begins with the order that Shri Krishna describes:

"Whether he is a science-minded person — he is a rationalist. The intellect is said to be superior to the mind. The mind is superior to the body, Krishna says, and superior to all three is the soul."

The same order appears in the Bhagavad Gita:

**indriyāṇi parāṇy āhur indriyebhyaḥ param
manaḥ
manasas tu parā buddhir yo buddheḥ paratas tu
saḥ**

"The senses are said to be superior; superior to the senses is the mind; superior to the mind is the intellect; and that which is beyond even the intellect is He — the soul."

— Bhagavad Gita 3.42

Acharya Ji makes clear where the person who believes in science stands in this order:

"Here comes the intellectual, the science-minded one, the man of science — Krishna says, this is the truly higher person. He is truly higher."

That is, the person who asks questions and tests things with the intellect is not wrong; on the contrary, **the intellect is a higher level than the mind.**

The Person of Feeling and the Person of Questions

Looking at today's religious life, Acharya Ji points out a difference:

"Among us today, in the temple, it is mostly the devotional person — of the mind, of feeling. All that is fine. But there is the person with higher-level questions — the kind of questions I had as a child."

Who can answer such questions? Acharya Ji says it plainly:

"To answer, you need someone of the intellect, or someone beyond the intellect — a realized master, who is called **sakshatkari**, one of the soul."

Sakshatkari means one who has directly experienced the soul. A person who stands on feeling alone is not enough for the questions of the intellect:

"That emotional person cannot answer him, and so it does not convince him."

Kali Yuga: The Age of the Intellect

Why has this question become so important today? Acharya Ji draws attention to the age we live in:

"And which yuga is running? Kali Yuga. What will Kali Yuga be? It will be the age of machines, the age of the intellect. That is why there are so many people of the intellect. They are not wrong."

The fault lies not with the one who asks, but with those who cannot answer — Acharya Ji states this directly:

"We cannot answer him — that is the problem."

And he names the questions:

- "How eight arms? How twelve arms?"
- "What is that elephant's trunk? What is its logic?"
- "If I do this puja, does it bear fruit?"

Why Is the Fruit Not Seen?

Phalashruti means the tangible fruit of a spiritual practice. Acharya Ji honestly admits that this is exactly what cannot be shown today:

"And that phalashruti of mantra sadhana cannot be shown. Is that the problem or not, tell me? The phalashruti cannot be shown."

He finds the cause in the method of practice:

"Your mantra siddhi — those mantras of yours have not been awakened. Our method itself went wrong — that is, we have not gone to the level of the soul, to a true Guru."

"There is only devotion going on, and only karma going on at the level of body-consciousness."

That is, devotion is stuck at the level of the mind, and action at the level of the body. **Without reaching the level of the soul, a true Guru, mantras do not awaken.**

Swami Chinmayananda's Prediction

That this situation would come had already been foretold. Acharya Ji recalls the words of Swami Chinmayananda:

"Swami Chinmayananda used to say that a time will come when rationalists will greatly increase, and then the devotional ones alone will not be able to answer. Then, somewhere, the Guru will have to awaken, and will have to answer him in the language of science."

In this age, the Guru's role is to be the bridge between science and spirituality.

Decoding the Scriptures

When this came back to his memory, Acharya Ji turned his work in that very direction:

"When this came to my memory — right — all our lectures, all our scriptures, this Durga Saptashati — we did them in decoding. Decoding means in a way that today's person will understand."

Decoding means finding the meaning of a story not in an outer event, but in our own inner experience. Acharya Ji gives an example:

"'Shiv ji said to Parvati' — no; my own soul told my mind and intellect."

In the same way, the meaning of the deities unfolds as inner powers:

"Ganapati — if you are doing this, then the discernment (vivek buddhi) within you must awaken. Well, then we began writing books in this language."

In this way Shiva and Parvati become the soul and the mind-intellect, and Ganapati means **the awakened discernment within us**. This is the language that convinces today's rational person.

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1 The intellect is superior to the mind**, and the soul is superior to all. The person who questions and believes in science is not wrong — he is "the truly higher person."
- 2 Devotion based on feeling alone** cannot answer the questions of the intellect. For that, one needs a realized Guru who has gone beyond the intellect.
- 3 Kali Yuga is the age of machines and of the intellect.** Questions like "how eight arms, what is the elephant's trunk" are natural; being unable to answer them is the real problem.

- 4 The fruit is not seen because the method has gone wrong.** Devotion has stopped at the level of the mind and action at the level of the body; without going to the level of the soul, to a true Guru, mantras do not awaken.
- 5 In this age the Guru will have to answer in the language of science** — this was Swami Chinmayananda's prediction.
- 6 Decoding the scriptures** — the story happens not outside but within us: Shiva is the soul, Parvati the mind-intellect, and Ganapati the awakened discernment.